

Σάτυρος ὁ Καλλατίδης

Satyrus of Callatis on Dionysian Genealogy

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Period: Ἑλληνιστική [Hellenistic](#)

Dialect: Κοινή [Koine](#)

Domain: Ἱστορία [History](#)

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Satyrus of Callatis was a Hellenistic historian and biographer of the 3rd century BCE from the city of Callatis, a Dorian colony on the Black Sea. He is often called "Satyrus the Peripatetic," an epithet likely reflecting the anecdotal style of his writing rather than a confirmed philosophical affiliation, and he appears to have been active in Ptolemaic Alexandria. The Suda identifies him as a philologist.

His major work was the *Lives*, a multi-volume collection of biographies. It survives only in fragments, primarily preserved by later authors like Athenaeus and Diogenes Laërtius. The most significant extant portion is his *Life of Euripides*, recovered from a papyrus roll. Other biographical subjects included Demosthenes, Dionysius I of Syracuse, and Sophocles.

Satyrus is a pivotal figure in the development of ancient biography. His method employed a distinctive, sometimes dialogic, narrative focused on character portrayal through anecdote, influencing later writers like Plutarch. The papyrus fragment of his *Life of Euripides* provides a crucial primary source for understanding early Hellenistic biographical technique, and his fragments remain valuable for their preserved historical and literary details.

Works (1)

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